

MS Excel — Assessment Test

50 Multiple Choice Questions | Modules 1–6 + Data Tab Tools

Name: _____

Date: _____

Roll No / ID: _____

Score: _____ / 50

Instructions: Each question carries 1 mark. Choose the single best answer (A, B, C, or D) for each question. There is no negative marking.

Module 1 — Excel Basics & Interface

1. What is the file extension of a Microsoft Excel workbook by default?

- (A) .xlsx
- (B) .xlwb
- (C) .docx
- (D) .pptx

2. In Excel, a single page or tab inside a workbook, made of rows and columns, is called a:

- (A) Ribbon
- (B) Worksheet
- (C) Cell
- (D) Workbook

3. The box on the Excel screen that shows the address of the currently selected cell (e.g., A1) is the:

- (A) Status Bar
- (B) Formula Bar
- (C) Name Box
- (D) Title Bar

4. The cell address for the intersection of Column D and Row 5 is written as:

- (A) D5
- (B) R5D
- (C) 5D
- (D) D-5

5. Which keyboard shortcut moves the active cell directly to A1 on a worksheet?

- (A) Ctrl + →
- (B) Ctrl + ↓
- (C) Ctrl + Home
- (D) Ctrl + End

6. Which ribbon feature would you use to make text visible on multiple lines within a single cell instead of being cut off?

- (A) Text Direction
- (B) Merge Cells
- (C) Wrap Text
- (D) AutoFit

7. What is the correct way to insert a new row in Excel?

- (A) Double-click on a column border
- (B) Press the Delete key on a selected row
- (C) Press Ctrl + S
- (D) Right-click the row number where you want the new row, then choose Insert

Module 2 — Working with Data

8. Which Paste option would you use if you copied a cell containing a formula, but only want to paste the resulting number (not the formula) into a new location?

- (A) Paste Formats
- (B) Paste Values
- (C) Paste Formulas
- (D) Transpose

9. The small square at the bottom-right corner of a selected cell, used to drag and continue a pattern into adjacent cells, is called the:

- (A) Fill Handle
- (B) Name Box
- (C) Quick Access marker
- (D) AutoSum button

10. Which Excel feature detects a pattern from an example you type (such as combining a first and last name) and automatically completes the rest of the column without a formula?

- (A) Paste Special
- (B) AutoFill
- (C) Text to Columns
- (D) Flash Fill

11. Which keyboard shortcut opens the Find and Replace dialog directly on the 'Replace' tab?

- (A) Ctrl + E
- (B) Ctrl + G
- (C) Ctrl + H
- (D) Ctrl + F

12. What is the key difference between Sort and Filter in Excel?

- (A) There is no difference

- (B) Sort hides rows; Filter reorders rows
- (C) Sort only works on numbers; Filter only works on text
- (D) Sort permanently reorders all rows; Filter only temporarily hides rows that don't match a condition

13. Which View tab feature keeps header rows visible at the top of the screen while you scroll down through a long list of data?

- (A) Split
- (B) Group
- (C) Hide
- (D) Freeze Panes

14. If a column of sensitive data needs to stay in the workbook but be temporarily out of view, which feature should you use?

- (A) Remove Duplicates
- (B) Delete
- (C) Freeze Panes
- (D) Hide

Module 3 — Formulas & Functions

15. Every formula in Excel must begin with which symbol?

- (A) @
- (B) =
- (C) +
- (D) #

16. Which type of cell reference changes automatically based on its new position when a formula is copied to another cell?

- (A) Relative reference (e.g., A1)
- (B) Mixed reference (e.g., \$A1)
- (C) Absolute reference (e.g., \$A\$1)
- (D) Named reference

17. Which key do you press after clicking a cell reference inside a formula to quickly convert it into an absolute reference (\$A\$1)?

- (A) F5
- (B) F9
- (C) F4
- (D) F2

18. Which function would you use to find the mean (average) of a range of numbers?

- (A) COUNT()
- (B) SUM()
- (C) AVERAGE()

(D) MEDIAN() only

19. Which function counts only the cells in a range that contain numbers, ignoring text entries?

- (A) COUNTIF()
- (B) COUNT()
- (C) COUNTA()
- (D) COUNTBLANK()

20. =ROUND(78.456, 1) will return which result?

- (A) 78.0
- (B) 78.5
- (C) 78.46
- (D) 78.4

21. To calculate the GST amount when a price is in cell B2 and the GST rate (stored as a plain number like 18) is in cell C2, which formula is correct?

- (A) =B2/C2*100
- (B) =B2*C2/100
- (C) =B2+C2
- (D) =B2*C2

Module 4 — Logical Functions

22. The IF() function in Excel is best described as a function that:

- (A) Always adds two numbers together
- (B) Automatically sorts a range
- (C) Only works with text values
- (D) Tests a condition and returns one value if TRUE, another if FALSE

23. In a nested IF formula with three IF() functions, how many closing brackets ')' are required at the end of the formula?

- (A) 4
- (B) 1
- (C) 2
- (D) 3

24. Which logical function returns TRUE only if every one of its listed conditions is TRUE?

- (A) NOT()
- (B) AND()
- (C) OR()
- (D) IF()

25. Which function would you use to add up salaries only for employees in the 'Sales' department, based on a condition?

- (A) AVERAGEIFS() alone without criteria
- (B) IF()
- (C) SUMIF()
- (D) COUNTIF()

26. When writing SUMIF or COUNTIF, how must a text criteria such as a department name be written in the formula?

- (A) Without quotes, e.g. Sales
- (B) In square brackets, e.g. [Sales]
- (C) Enclosed in double quotes, e.g. "Sales"
- (D) As a cell reference only, never typed directly

27. What is the main purpose of wrapping a VLOOKUP formula inside IFERROR()?

- (A) To convert text results into numbers
- (B) To make the VLOOKUP search faster
- (C) To automatically fix incorrect lookup values
- (D) To replace an error like #N/A with a custom, meaningful message instead

28. Which error typically appears when a VLOOKUP formula cannot find a matching value in the lookup table?

- (A) #DIV/0!
- (B) #N/A
- (C) #VALUE!
- (D) #REF!

Module 5 — Data Management

29. Conditional Formatting in Excel is used to:

- (A) Restrict what can be typed into a cell
- (B) Automatically calculate the sum of a range
- (C) Merge multiple cells into one
- (D) Automatically change a cell's appearance based on its value, without manual coloring

30. Which feature would you use to restrict a cell so users can only choose from a fixed drop-down list of options (e.g., Pending, Completed, Cancelled)?

- (A) Conditional Formatting
- (B) Freeze Panes
- (C) Data Validation
- (D) Text to Columns

31. Which tool splits one column of combined text (e.g., 'Laptop-North') into two separate columns using a delimiter like a dash?

- (A) Flash Fill only
- (B) Text to Columns

- (C) Remove Duplicates
- (D) Data Validation

32. Which chart type is best suited for showing how a value changes over time, such as monthly sales growth?

- (A) Column Chart only
- (B) Bar Chart
- (C) Pie Chart
- (D) Line Chart

33. Before printing a worksheet that has extra stray data far below the main table, which setting should you configure to avoid printing many blank or extra pages?

- (A) Print Area
- (B) Freeze Panes
- (C) Page Orientation
- (D) Header & Footer

34. Which Excel feature automatically deletes rows that are exact repeats of other rows in a dataset?

- (A) Remove Duplicates
- (B) Text to Columns
- (C) Sort
- (D) Data Validation

35. In Conditional Formatting, which visual option shows an in-cell bar whose length is proportional to the cell's value, making relative size easy to compare at a glance?

- (A) Custom Rule only
- (B) Color Scales
- (C) Icon Sets
- (D) Data Bars

Module 6 — Advanced Excel (Lookups & Pivot)

36. VLOOKUP searches for a value in the leftmost column of a table and then:

- (A) Searches every sheet in the workbook automatically
- (B) Returns the row number of the match
- (C) Only works with numeric lookup values
- (D) Returns a value from another column in that same row

37. HLOOKUP is different from VLOOKUP mainly because HLOOKUP:

- (A) Can only return text values
- (B) Automatically updates when data changes, unlike VLOOKUP
- (C) Requires no lookup_value argument
- (D) Searches across the first row of a table instead of the first column

38. Which of the following is an advantage of XLOOKUP over VLOOKUP?

- (A) It does not require specifying a lookup_value
- (B) It can only be used with numbers
- (C) It can search in any direction and has a built-in way to handle 'not found' results
- (D) It works only in Excel 2010

39. In the combination INDEX() + MATCH(), what is the role of MATCH()?

- (A) It finds the position of a value within a range
- (B) It returns the final value from a table
- (C) It sorts the data before lookup
- (D) It formats the result as currency

40. Which of these tasks can INDEX+MATCH do that plain VLOOKUP cannot do on its own?

- (A) Look to the left of the lookup column
- (B) Work inside an IF() formula
- (C) Return a number instead of text
- (D) Search for exact text matches

41. A Pivot Table lets you summarize large datasets by dragging fields into which four areas?

- (A) Header, Footer, Body, Margin
- (B) Rows, Columns, Values, Filters
- (C) Input, Output, Formula, Result
- (D) Sort, Filter, Group, Chart

42. What is the purpose of a Slicer when used with a Pivot Table?

- (A) It provides a clickable button-style filter for the Pivot Table and its connected Pivot Chart
- (B) It deletes duplicate values from the source data
- (C) It converts the Pivot Table into a regular table
- (D) It automatically sorts the Pivot Table alphabetically

Data Tab Tools (Outline & Analysis)

43. Which Data tab tool automatically inserts summary rows (like Sum or Average) every time a chosen column's value changes, and also builds an outline for you?

- (A) Subtotal
- (B) Consolidate
- (C) Group
- (D) Data Validation

44. Before using the Subtotal tool on a dataset, what must be done to the data first?

- (A) It must have all blank cells removed
- (B) It must be formatted as currency
- (C) It must be sorted by the column you will subtotal on
- (D) It must be converted to a Pivot Table

45. In the Outline group, which pair of buttons manually expands or collapses a grouped section without deleting any data?

- (A) Show Detail / Hide Detail
- (B) Sort / Filter
- (C) Merge / Unmerge
- (D) Freeze / Split

46. The Consolidate tool is best used when you need to:

- (A) Split one column into multiple columns
- (B) Restrict what values can be typed into a cell
- (C) Merge several identically-structured ranges (e.g., monthly tables) into one summary using a function like Sum
- (D) Automatically color cells based on their value

47. In the Consolidate dialog, ticking 'Left column' means Excel will:

- (A) Automatically delete the leftmost column after consolidating
- (B) Sort the data alphabetically before merging
- (C) Match and combine rows by their row labels rather than by position alone
- (D) Ignore the leftmost column entirely

48. Which What-If Analysis tool works backward — you specify the output you want, and Excel finds the single input value needed to reach it?

- (A) Goal Seek
- (B) Consolidate
- (C) Data Table
- (D) Scenario Manager

49. In Goal Seek, the 'Set cell' field must contain:

- (A) A cell formatted as a date
- (B) A formula, not a hardcoded typed number
- (C) A blank cell only
- (D) Text data only

50. Which What-If Analysis tool allows you to save several different named sets of input values (e.g., Best Case, Worst Case) and switch between them instantly?

- (A) Subtotal
- (B) Goal Seek
- (C) Data Table
- (D) Scenario Manager